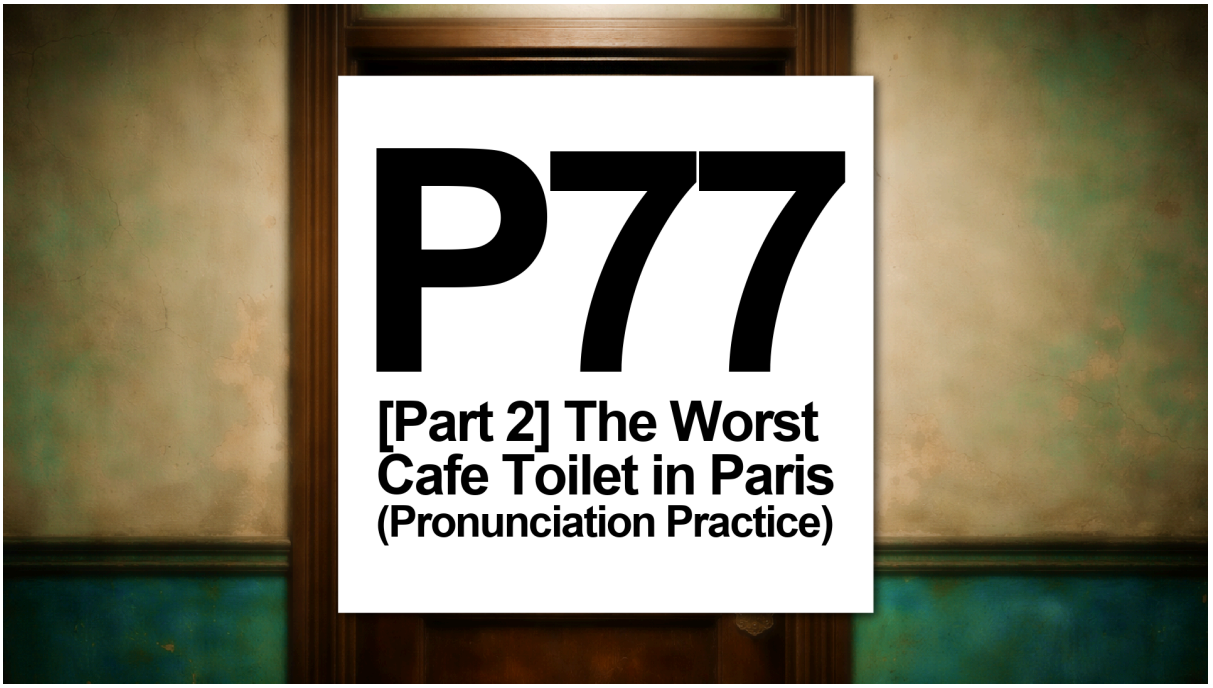

Welcome back to LEP Premium. This is P77 part 2. It is called The Worst Cafe Toilet in Paris and it is for pronunciation practice.

This is a story to help you practise pronouncing most of the vocabulary from part 1 of this series, in context.

This is here to give you a convenient way to practise shadowing, repeating after me, with a focus on natural, fluent speech, including words and phrases we have already studied.

Repeat each line after me and try to focus on

- Connecting all the words together in each "chunk", especially with certain forms of connected speech (shown with <u>underlined letters</u>)
- Stressing the right syllables in each chunk (shown with **large bold lett**ers

- Using schwa sounds in weak forms for small unstressed words like articles, prepositions (unless they are in phrasal verbs) and other little grammar words (shown with small letters)

I might give a few comments along the way - perhaps to point out bits of connected speech or other details, so if you would rather just have the lines with no comments at all, check out the other recording which is just me repeating each line with absolutely no other interruptions or comments. The link for that is in the description.

The Worst Café Toilet in Paris

Last week**end** I **vis**ited a small **ca**fé in **Pa**ris.

Now, **nor**mally I'm quite opti**mis**tic.

You **could say** I'm more of a glass half **full** type of **per**son.

But this par**ti**cular day pushed my **op**timism to its **lim**its.

I had **gone** there **par**tly to work on a **pod**cast episode called Room 10**1**.

I was pre**par**ing a **list** of **things** that an**noy** me,

and I'd come **up** with quite a **lot**.

So I had to narrow it **down** to just a few **i**tems.

My **first** complaint con**cern**ed public **toi**lets,

specifically toilet paper dispensers.

In my opinion toilet paper dispensers should be transparent,

so you can easily see how much paper is left

in order to plan your toilet visit effectively

Unfortunately,

the one in this café was completely opaque.

You couldn't see anything inside it.

And of course the inevitable happened.

At the worst possible moment,

just when I needed it the most,

the toilet paper ran out.

Now, in that situation the design of the dispenser suddenly becomes quite a pressing concern.

I tried to open the dispenser to get more paper,

but it was securely fastened to the wall and impossible to move.

My **box**er shorts were **around** my **an**kles and my poor **rear end** was **dan**gerously ex**pose**d.

Suddenly the automatic **clean**ing system **act**ivated and produced a **strange mis**ty **spray** of **wa**ter.

Naturally I tried to **shim**my **side**ways to a**void** it.

But **then** something even **worse** happened.

Two small **sprink**lers suddenly popped **up** from the **floor**,

soaking my **trou**sers.

At **this** point I realised that I had com**ple**tely run **out** of **toi**let **pa**per

just when I **need**ed it **most**

I **look**ed at the **emp**ty disp**en**ser and thought,

"I really could **do** with a **lot** more **pap**er than **this**, for **sev**eral **rea**sons."

I**ron**ically, the café **ow**ner later dis**cov**ered that **sev**eral **cus**tomers had actually suffered **food** poisoning from the **food**.

But in**stead** of **worr**ying about **that**,

he seemed **more** concerned with comp**lete**ly superf**ici**al things

— like whether the bathroom looked nice.

He said the interior design needed to be more aesthetic.

Personally I think when you're in a situation like I was,

the design of the bathroom becomes slightly less important than simply having enough toilet paper.

Sorry, this story is a bit gross isn't it?

I hope you don't mind all the details.

Anyway, after everything that happened that day, the broken toilet dispenser truly became the final straw.

You'll probably agree that it was all a bit too much,

unless of course you're inclined to enjoy this kind of story.

And if you are, then congratulations.

You've just survived perhaps the most ridiculous vocabulary lesson I've ever created.